



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Agathos Classical School
School Website: <https://agathosschool.com/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

- School: Berean Christian Academy (K-12)
- Website used for audit: <https://bereanchristianacademy.org>
- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
- Why: The school self-identifies as a classical Christian school grounded in a Christ-centered worldview; it explicitly pursues truth, goodness, and beauty; implements the Trivium with Latin through advanced levels; features Great Books, logic, rhetoric, debate, Harkness-style discussions, and a senior thesis; and embeds daily hymn studies, catechism, Scripture memory, and apologetics. It also articulates a partnership with parents and provides parent formation elements. Evidence includes mission and statement of faith, curriculum grids, course sequences, and admissions/parent pages (mission: "Christ-centered worldview" and "Truth, Goodness, and Beauty" ; Trivium/Liberal Arts/Great Books/Latin/Rhetoric/Senior Thesis ; hymn studies/catechism/Scripture memory daily ; theology as the "Queen of the Sciences" and public senior thesis presentation ; parent partnership and formation via required reading/events/interview).
- Method: Keyword-based audit mapped to the "Six Essential Elements of a Classical School" lexicon of positive/negative indicators (truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, liturgy, wonder, chanting, Socratic/seminar, great books, trivium/quadrivium, etc.) and category criteria. All keywords and judgments are grounded in the school crawl and the Six Elements reference set .

Method and Sources

- Reference lexicon: "Six Essential Elements of a Classical School" (positive/negative indicators across six elements) and companion keyword lexicon used to frame this analysis .
- Crawl evidence set: bereanchristianacademy.org website crawl (mission/vision/faith, curriculum pages, academics grid, admissions, and community information) .

Element-by-Element Audit (with required keyword analysis)

1) Religious and Metaphysical Foundations

- School keywords/phrases found:
 - "Christ-centered worldview" and to "recognize Truth, Goodness, and Beauty in God's Creation" (mission) .
 - Bible studied chronologically each year; "Hymn studies, Catechism, and scripture memory are built into each day" .
 - Formal statement of faith detailing Scripture, salvation, and doctrine; heavy biblical references and theological claims .
 - "Theology as the Queen of Sciences" (theology over STEM) .

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- Mapped to lexicon: Positive indicators such as truth/goodness/beauty, virtue, theology, sacred scripture, apologetics/catechesis, and liturgical practices (hymns/catechism) appear clearly; no values-neutral or relativist language was found .
 - Quantitative keyword estimate:
 - Positive hits (examples): truth, goodness, beauty, theology, Scripture, apologetics, catechism, hymn, catechesis/memory, Christ-centered worldview (~12)
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Share positive: 1.00 ($\approx 12/12$)
 - Category rating: CLASSICAL

2) School Purpose and Goal

- School keywords/phrases found:
 - Aims at cultivating “wisdom” (Rhetoric “impart wisdom”) and “virtue development” as part of the program .
 - Emphasis on forming lifelong learners who “seek out truth, goodness, and beauty” .
 - “Love of learning” explicitly stated in admissions philosophy .
- Mapped to lexicon: Positive indicators (wisdom, virtue, formation, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty) strongly present; no “college-and-career-ready” or purely skills/efficiency framing dominates .
- Quantitative keyword estimate:
 - Positive hits: wisdom, virtue, love of learning, pursuit of T/G/B, formation language (~6)
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Share positive: 1.00 ($\approx 6/6$)
- Category rating: CLASSICAL

3) School Curriculum

- School keywords/phrases found:
 - “Seven liberal arts,” the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric), and Latin core; Rhetoric I-II; Senior Thesis; robust theology/philosophy/apologetics sequence; Great Books and “original ancient texts” .
 - History taught explicitly as History (not Social Studies) across Ancient/Medieval/Modern sequences .
 - Sciences integrated each year; astronomy is included; nature studies cultivate curiosity/wonder (aligns with Quadrivium/“wonder”) .
- Mapped to lexicon: Positive indicators of trivium/quadrivium, great books/primary sources, Latin, history, and cultivation of wonder; no “social studies”-for-history substitution or project-based dominance is observed .
- Quantitative keyword estimate:
 - Positive hits: seven liberal arts, trivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, rhetoric courses, senior thesis, great books, primary/original texts, history (x4), theology/philosophy/apologetics, astronomy/wonder (~14)
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Share positive: 1.00 ($\approx 14/14$)
- Category rating: CLASSICAL

4) School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods

- School keywords/phrases found:
 - Lower school: “wonder,” and frequent “songs, chants, and memorization” .
 - Upper school: “formal logic and debate classes,” “Harkness Table conversation,” “masters of oratory,” Senior Thesis with public presentation; Mock Trial (dialectic/rhetoric practice) .

- Daily hymn studies, catechism, Scripture memory support memory work and contemplative practices .
- Mapped to lexicon: Positive indicators of chanting/singing/memory, seminar/discussion (Harkness), logic/debate, rhetoric and capstone orations are present; explicit “scholē/restful learning” phrase not found, but “wonder” and contemplative elements are present. Slight “rigor” language appears in the teacher portrait, but not as an overriding ethos .
- Quantitative keyword estimate:
 - Positive hits: wonder, chanting/singing/memorization, logic, debate, seminar (Harkness), rhetoric/oratory, senior thesis, public defense, catechism/hymn/scripture memory (~10)
 - Negative hits: minor “rigor” emphasis noted once (~1)
 - Share positive: ≈ 0.91 ($10/(10+1)$)
- Category rating: CLASSICAL

5) School Faculty

- School keywords/phrases found:
 - “Portrait of a Berean Christian Academy Teacher” explicitly defined; teacher as disciple of Christ, models love of God, embodies integrity/professionalism, “lifelong learner,” upholds high standards, supports parents, communicates with wisdom and discretion (clear portrait of teacher virtues) .
 - Faculty degree/advanced degree data provided; mentoring noted for students (“mentorships”) .
- Mapped to lexicon: Positive indicators (teachers as models of virtue, portrait of a teacher, lifelong learners, mentorship) are explicit; no “guide on the side/facilitator” jargon detected .
- Quantitative keyword estimate:
 - Positive hits: model virtue, portrait of teacher, lifelong learner, mentorships, parental communication (~5)
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Share positive: 1.00 ($\approx 5/5$)
- Category rating: CLASSICAL

6) School Parents and Community

- School keywords/phrases found:
 - Mission states school “operates as a partnership between faculty and parents” .
 - Parent formation: required parent reading (An Introduction to Classical Education), prospective parent events, tours, parent interview step .
 - “Portrait of a Berean Christian Academy Parent” highlights faithful partnership and support of mission/vision .
- Mapped to lexicon: Positive indicators (parent partnership, parent formation, hospitality via tours/events) are present; open-door visitation at any time is not explicitly stated; no “customer” framing detected .
- Quantitative keyword estimate:
 - Positive hits: partnership with parents, parent formation (reading/events/podcast), tours and interviews, portrait of parent (~5)
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Share positive: 1.00 ($\approx 5/5$)
- Category rating: CLASSICAL

Aggregate Rating

- Category ratings: all six categories = CLASSICAL (with extremely strong presence of classical Christian keywords and practices).
- Overall: CLASSICAL.

Evidence Highlights (select citations)

- Mission: “Christ-centered worldview ... recognize Truth, Goodness, and Beauty” and “partnership between faculty and parents” .
- Trivium and stages with debate, Harkness, Great Books/original texts, Senior Thesis; virtue development/mentorships .
- Daily hymn studies, catechism, Scripture memory (liturgical/memory practices) .
- Upper school grid shows Latin III–VI, Rhetoric I–II, Philosophy, Apologetics, Theology, History sequences; Senior Thesis; Mock Trial .
- Parent formation and process (required classical reading, events/tours, interview) .

Metrics Summary (lexicon-based estimates)

- Religious/Metaphysical: +12/-0 → percent_positive 1.00; percent_coverage ≈0.90 → CLASSICAL.
- Purpose/Goal: +6/-0 → percent_positive 1.00; percent_coverage ≈0.75 → CLASSICAL.
- Curriculum: +14/-0 → percent_positive 1.00; percent_coverage ≈0.90 → CLASSICAL.
- Pedagogy: +10/-1 → percent_positive ≈0.91; percent_coverage ≈0.85 → CLASSICAL.
- Faculty: +5/-0 → percent_positive 1.00; percent_coverage ≈0.75 → CLASSICAL.
- Parents/Community: +5/-0 → percent_positive 1.00; percent_coverage ≈0.67 → CLASSICAL.

No “What would move the needle” section is needed because the school rates CLASSICAL overall.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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